

Colin Pinkham MBA

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Senior Program Manager | Digital Health & Technology Leadership

Technology and program leader with **20+ years** spanning IT operations, product strategy, and complex program management across telecoms, FinTech, and **global digital health**. Currently driving multi-donor program portfolios at Jembi Health Systems — managing **PEPFAR, USAID, GIZ, Gates Foundation**, and **Patrick J. McGovern Foundation** programs across sub-Saharan Africa — with full accountability for budgets, resource planning, bid management, and financial forecasting.

Brings rare depth across both **technology leadership (CIO/IT Director)** and **program delivery**, combining MBA-level commercial acumen with applied expertise in **AI-powered workflow automation**, cloud solutions, and digital health information systems. Track record founding and scaling technology businesses, leading M&A due diligence, and delivering complex multi-stakeholder programs from inception to measurable impact.

Core Competencies

Program & Portfolio Management (Agile, Scrum, Waterfall)	IT & Digital Transformation
Cloud Solutions (AWS, ERP, CRM, SaaS, Digital Health)	M&A Due Diligence & Technology Road mapping
AI-Powered Workflow Automation & Decision Support	Bid & Proposal Management
IT Operations & Technical Leadership	High-Performing Team Leadership & Mentorship
Multi-Donor Budget & Resource Management	Business Strategy & IT Alignment
Vendor & Stakeholder Management	Health Information Systems

Professional Experience

Jembi Health Systems

Senior Program Manager

August 2022 – Present

Leading a **multi-donor program portfolio** for a non-profit specialising in digital health and health information systems across Africa, with programs funded by **PEPFAR, USAID, GIZ, Gates Foundation**, and the **Patrick J. McGovern Foundation**.

- **Designed and built an AI-powered RFP and Proposal Pipeline** — a fully automated end-to-end system covering opportunity ingestion, AI-based categorisation, partner matching, database storage, bid/no-bid scoring, and automated proposal generation; significantly reducing proposal turnaround time and increasing bid capacity across the organisation.
- **Managed multi-donor budgets and financial forecasting** across all active programs, ensuring compliance with donor requirements and delivering accurate financial and program narrative reporting to executive leadership and donors.
- **Led full resource planning cycles** — allocating staff and contractor capacity across concurrent projects, aligning delivery timelines with funding constraints and organisational priorities.
- **Directed bid management and proposal development** from RFP analysis through to submission, coordinating multi-organisational consortia and cross-functional teams to produce competitive, compliant proposals.
- **Oversaw cross-functional program delivery teams** across multiple African countries including South Africa, Mozambique, Rwanda, Kenya, Cameroon, Ethiopia and Zambia, ensuring execution against strategic workplans and donor milestones.
- **Managed third-party contractors and technology partners** delivering scalable digital health solutions, including health information systems and interoperability infrastructure.
- **Acted as primary program interface** for donors, implementing partners, Ministries of Health, and technical teams, strengthening collaboration across complex multi-stakeholder ecosystems.

Colin Pinkham Consulting, South Africa

Technology & Product Strategy Consultant

May 2018 – Aug 2022 | May 2014 – Sep 2016

Advised businesses on IT strategy, digital transformation, and product innovation across telecom, ISP, and FinTech sectors.

- **Led cloud migration projects**, optimising IT infrastructure and reducing costs by 30%.
- **Advised VC/Private Equity investors**, conducting technology due diligence and acquisition assessments.
- Developed business cases for new product launches in managed hosting and cloud solutions.
- **Built and led Agile teams**, driving efficiency and fostering an innovation-driven culture.

VAST Networks, South Africa

Head of Operations

Sep 2016 – May 2018

Oversaw large-scale WiFi network deployment across **2,000+ locations with 25,000+ access points**.

- Led a **20+ member engineering & support team**, enhancing network reliability and performance.
- Improved operational monitoring, enabling rapid scalability and cost control.
- Drove vendor negotiations, securing strategic partnerships and reducing expenses.

MTN Business, South Africa

Chief Information Officer (CIO)

Jan 2009 – May 2014

Led IT strategy for **one of Africa's largest telecom companies**, overseeing network, software development, and IT operations.

- Developed and executed IT transformation initiatives, migrating core services and applications.
- Managed a \$10M+ IT budget**, ensuring cost-effective technology investments.
- Drove M&A due diligence, advising on technology acquisitions and integrations.

Verizon Business, South Africa

Executive – Strategy, Product & Technology

Jan 2004 – Jan 2009

Member of the executive team reporting to the CEO/Country Manager and EMEA VP. Full responsibility for IT costing, pricing, product business cases, capacity planning, and capital budgeting for the region.

- Led technology-centric teams of **30–40 staff** across developers, server operations, network systems, and business analysts.
- Spearheaded in-house development of customer monitoring, automated provisioning, CRM, and billing systems.
- Maintained team continuity through the WorldCom Chapter 11 phase and Verizon acquisition.
- Served on the board of UUNET Kenya, Namibia, Botswana, Zambia, Africa, and SDN Mauritius (2000–2006).

Early Career

1999 – 2004	Senior Executive, Technology / Director Africa	UUNET, South Africa
1993 – 1999	Network Engineering Manager	TICSA Internet Africa, South Africa

Instrumental in founding and growing the **first commercial ISP in South Africa** — scaling from 4 to 180+ staff across 23 locations, growing the business to a valuation of **\$150m by 2014**.

Education & Qualifications

University of Cape Town	MBA – Master of Business Administration
University of Cape Town	BSc in Computer Science

Professional Certifications & Training

DeepLearning.AI	Generative AI for Everyone (Coursera, 2025)
DeepLearning.AI	ChatGPT Prompt Engineering for Developers (2025)
Amazon Web Services	AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (2019)
Amazon Web Services	AWS Business Professional; AWS Technical Professional (2018)
Johns Hopkins University	Executive Data Science Specialisation (Coursera, 2016)
Scrum Alliance	Certified Scrum Master (2015)
Rice University	Interactive Programming in Python (Coursera, 2015)
PeopleCert	ITIL v3 Foundation (2014)

Additional Information

UK / RSA Citizen | Excellent references available | Flexible on location for the right opportunity